MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Students select and import their video. Study the clip.	Slides 1–6: the hook (a scene with the sound off, then on), what a score does, the seven classes, steps 1 and 2, and choosing a clip. Hand out the project sheet, the Clip log and the Watch notes.	Slides 1–6	p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Plan the score — mark key moments, decide on mood and instrumentation.	Slides 7–11: the timeline, a live demo of markers in Logic, bars and seconds, the score plan, shaping the dynamics. Then students fill in the Score plan and the Cue sheet.	Slides 7–11	p. 15, p. 16, p. 10
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — compose, layer, and sync the score.	Slide 12: compose, starting with the backbone. Then work time.	Slide 12	p. 17
CLASS 4		Slide 13: sync and refine; check each hit point against the picture. Then work time.	Slide 13	—
CLASS 5		Full working day: layer, sync and shape the dynamics. Ask each student to play you one hit point and tell you where it lands.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce, sync audio to video. Prepare presentations.	Slides 14–16: finalize and bounce, what you turn in, the rubric. Students self-score, bounce and post their three questions.	Slides 14–16	p. 21, p. 23
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 17–18: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions.	Slides 17–18	p. 23

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

From my common struggles: steer students to a clip with 1–2 minutes of actual scored content. Slide 6 and the clip checks on page 4 are your script, and page 13 is where students record where their clip comes from.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Slides 12 and 13 open Classes 3 and 4; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: where is your next hit point, and what does the music do there?

PREVIEW

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MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Cue sheet

STUDENT

Class 2

Name _____ Date _____

Tempo: _____ **BPM. One bar =** _____ **seconds (4 × 60 ÷ BPM). Frame rate:** _____

Mark every hit point on the video with a marker in Logic, then list it here. Use the markers to read the time. Bar.beat = the bar and beat where the music should hit.

#	TIME (M:SS)	TIMECODE	BAR.BEAT	WHAT HAPPENS ON SCREEN	WHAT THE MUSIC DOES

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TIP

Start with at least three hit points. If a hit does not land on a beat, try a different tempo, or hit the moment with a stinger instead (page 10).

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STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Choose a 2–3 minute video clip (your own or from YouTube/Vimeo)
- ☐ Compose a fully formed piece of music that complements the visuals
- ☐ At least some musical elements must be timed to the visuals
- ☐ Sound effects are optional but encouraged
- ☐ Export your composition as .mp3 or .wav and sync it to the video for presentation

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Choose your video** — Find a 2–3 minute clip that inspires you. Import it into Logic. (Clip log: page 13)
2. **Study the video** — Watch it multiple times. Note the mood, pacing, and key visual moments. (Watch notes: page 14)
3. **Plan your score** — Decide where the music builds, drops, shifts, and hits visual cues. (Score plan: page 15; cue sheet: page 16)
4. **Compose** — Build your score in Logic. Start with the backbone and layer in detail.
5. **Sync and refine** — Fine-tune timing to the visuals. Add sound effects if desired. (Sync log: page 17)
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your audio and prepare the video with your music for presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Music for Visual Media | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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